

In recent years, the Ministry of Railways has initiated several measures for railway preservation including public awareness programmes, workshops, and exhibitions. Its Heritage Directorate recently collaborated with Google Arts and Culture for a virtual documentation of railway heritage, titled “The Lifeline of a Nation”. Combining journeys, people’s stories, engineering marvels, and heritage, the railways come alive with just a click. There have also been many remarkable private initiatives as well, such as the Indian Railways Fan Club Association (IRFCA). The website, set up by a group of rail fans engaged in documenting railways, is a goldmine of information related to the Indian Railways.



▲ **Austin Car**, which was used as an inspection carriage, is now displayed at the Railway Museum, Mysore.

“Much like India itself, the **Indian Railways** has a bit of both, **heritage** and **modernity** ... enchanting **vintage trains** ... services like **Vande Bharat** ... breathtaking new **bridges** ... dramatically further the railways’ **reach** and **connectivity**.”

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